SIH 2026

Problem Statement Discovery & Shortlisted Directions

1. Team Context

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Objective: Identify a high-impact, unique and technically feasible real-world problem for Smart India Hackathon 2026.
Presentation: 3 September 2026

2. What Makes a Strong SIH Problem

A strong problem should have an identifiable user, a genuine real-world pain point, a measurable impact, a clear gap in existing solutions, realistic prototype feasibility, meaningful technical depth and potential to scale.

3. Shortlisted Problem Areas

Priority	Area	Why It Is Interesting	Initial Potential
1	Digital Fraud Prevention & Response	Citizens face phishing, impersonation, payment scams and social-engineering attacks. A strong opportunity may exist around prevention, real-time decision support and post-incident guidance.	Very High
2	Cybersecurity for MSMEs	Small businesses may have limited security staff, budgets and technical expertise while still handling valuable digital data.	Very High
3	Government Service Accessibility	Citizens may struggle with eligibility, documents, procedures, deadlines and finding the correct official service.	High
4	Public Safety / Emergency Response	Fast and accurate emergency coordination is important, but the idea must clearly differentiate itself from existing systems such as 112.	High, with strong differentiation

4. Direction 1 — Digital Fraud Prevention & Response

Core problem: People may receive fraudulent messages, links, QR codes, calls or payment requests without enough context to determine whether the interaction is legitimate before money or personal information is lost.

Potential innovation: Analyse suspicious digital interactions, provide an understandable risk assessment, explain the warning signs, recommend a safe immediate action and guide victims toward verified reporting and recovery channels.

Key differentiation: Do not build another generic cybercrime-reporting portal. Focus on prevention, real-time decision support and simplified guidance.

5. Direction 2 — Affordable Cybersecurity for MSMEs

Core problem: Micro and small businesses increasingly depend on digital systems but may lack dedicated security teams, expensive monitoring platforms and the expertise needed to identify attacks early.

Potential innovation: A lightweight cybersecurity guardian that detects suspicious logins, phishing, abnormal file activity, ransomware indicators and other risky behaviour, then converts technical findings into clear actions for a business owner.

Technical angle: Behavioural detection, alert prioritisation, incident response, cloud dashboard and secure architecture.

6. Direction 3 — Government Service Accessibility

Core problem: Finding a government service is only one part of the challenge. Citizens may still struggle with eligibility, required documents, application steps, deadlines and identifying the correct official source.

Potential innovation: A multilingual, citizen-friendly assistant that converts a user's need into relevant services, explains requirements and provides a step-by-step application path using trusted official sources.

Key differentiation: Improve discovery and completion instead of simply reproducing an existing government portal.

7. Direction 4 — Public Safety / Emergency Response

Core problem: Emergency situations can produce fragmented, incomplete and time-sensitive information, making rapid incident understanding and coordination difficult.

Potential innovation: An emergency-intelligence layer that converts citizen voice, text, image, video and location inputs into structured incident information, estimates severity and helps responders prioritise actionable information.

Key differentiation: Existing emergency infrastructure such as 112 means a new idea must solve a specific intelligence or coordination gap rather than simply creating another emergency-call application.

8. Promising Intersection — Digital Safety for Citizens

Possible direction: A citizen-focused digital safety platform connecting prevention, real-time guidance and post-incident assistance.

Possible flow: Suspicious interaction → Risk analysis → Plain-language explanation → Immediate safe action → Evidence preservation → Verified reporting/recovery guidance.

Important: This is a discovery direction, not the final SIH problem statement. The exact gap must be validated against official SIH material, existing solutions and real user needs.

9. Final Selection Framework

Criterion	Question to Ask
Real-world impact	Who is suffering from this problem, and how serious is the consequence?
Existing gap	What do current government or commercial solutions fail to solve?
Novelty	What is genuinely different about the proposed approach?
Feasibility	Can the core solution be built and demonstrated within the SIH timeline?
Technical depth	Does the problem require meaningful engineering rather than a basic CRUD application?
Scalability	Can the idea serve more users, locations or organisations later?
Demo strength	Can judges understand the value quickly through a convincing prototype?

10. Team Discussion Goal

Do not select an idea only because it sounds impressive. Compare evidence, existing solutions, innovation gap, feasibility and demo potential. The final statement should describe the **problem first**; the technology and product should come after the problem is validated.